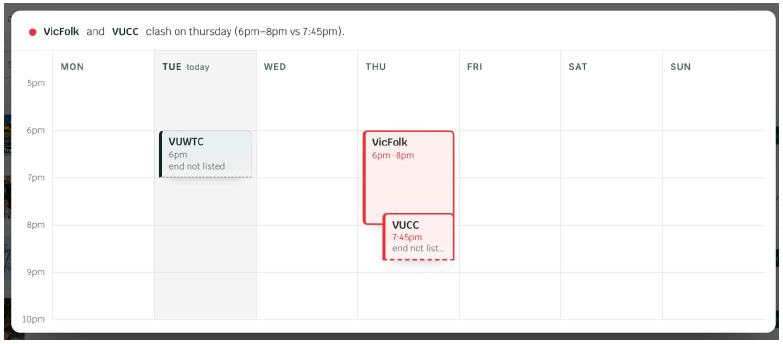
SWEN303 GROUP 4 · ITERATION 2

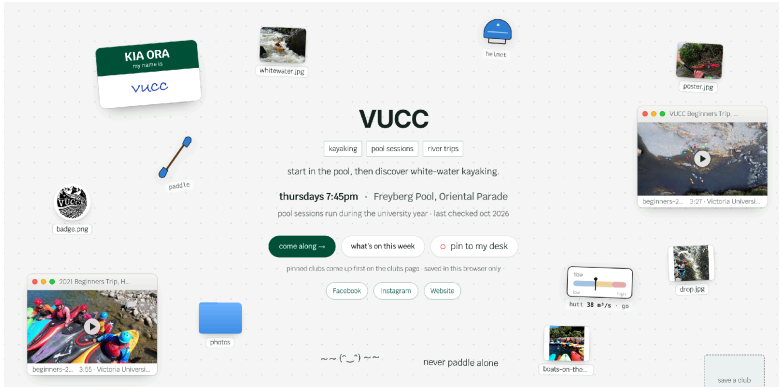
vuw clubs.: from “I know where to go” to “I know how to start”

Iteration 1 ended with seven fixes and six things to keep. Iteration 2 refines the same site rather than rebuilding it. This report shows what changed, why, and how the next test will check it.

01 BEFORE DESIGN What testing told us · what Iteration 2 set out to change
02 DURING DESIGN User flows · Figma designs · palette and type · seven built before-and-afters
03 AFTER DESIGN Journey · test plan · Nielsen review, then and now







01 BEFORE DESIGN / ITERATION 1 TESTING

Finding and deciding worked. Joining did not.

Three moderated sessions in October 2026 on the Iteration 1 build, one per persona. Full results are in the Iteration 1 report, pp. 27–31.

Ben · Social Explorer · 7–8 / 10

Judged clubs by their videos and liked the interactive desk. Found the text “all clumped” and wanted costs, dates and what to bring grouped. Did not notice the pile, asked what “catch” did, and had to ask “How do I join?”.

Theo · Advance Planner · about 9 / 10

Found it “pretty straightforward” once on a club page. Preferred the green VUW version: “at least feels like it belongs to the same school.” Moving posters took “four or five” clicks. Wanted clubs side by side.

Liv · folk-club member · shown a demo first

Found the club’s email, but: “if I’m a new student, I don’t know that’s how you join a club.” Saw her own club listed on the wrong day and in the wrong rooms. Typed “debate”; Vic Debsoc did not appear.

How the five user tasks went

Task	Result (old site)	What happened
T1 Find a club that fits my free time	Done after a hint	Meeting times were easy to find, but testers did not notice the saved-clubs pile until the facilitator pointed to it
T2 Decide if a club suits me	Done	The videos helped them decide; the text felt too heavy to read
T3 Prepare for my first visit	Failed without help	There was no way to join on the club page; Ben had to ask “How do I join?”
T4 Check the latest plan before going again	Not tested	No session gave this task, but Liv noticed her own club’s day and rooms were wrong
T5 Look up a club someone mentioned	Mixed	Searching “debate” found nothing, because search only matched club names

What to keep: valued by at least two testers

Keep	In Iteration 2	Page
Pictures and videos first	Still first on every club page; previews stay muted until clicked	15
Saving clubs to compare	Renamed “save”; saved clubs can also be seen on one week	11–12
Day filters and times on every row	Unchanged; they now share a bar with the search box	14
One club page for everything	The same six windows for every club; each desk has its own objects	7, 16
The golem, made quieter	Kept, now in a graduation gown. Not made quieter yet	18
Real, current club content	Same six clubs; each meeting line says when it was last checked	15

01 BEFORE DESIGN / PLAN FOR ITERATION 2

What Iteration 2 changed for each task

The middle column is how each task went on the old site in Iteration 1 testing. Iteration 2 has not been tested yet, so no task is confirmed as passed; page 18 is the plan to check them.

User task	Iteration 1 test (old site)	What Iteration 2 changed	Iteration 2	Pages
T1 Find a club that fits my free time	Done after a hint: the saved-clubs pile went unnoticed	“catch” became “save”; a bigger “my clubs” pile; a week view that shows clashes	**Built, not tested**	11–12
T2 Decide if a club suits me	Done, but the text felt too heavy	Name, three tags and one line at the top; each window looks like its app; each club’s desk has its own objects	**Built, not tested**	15–16
T3 Prepare for my first visit	Failed without help: no way to join on the page	A sign-up form on the club page; “come along →” on every club page	**Built, not tested**	10
T4 Check the latest plan before going again	Not tested; Liv found her club’s details were wrong	Each meeting line says when it was last checked and where the club posts changes. Clubs cannot yet update their own page	**Partly built**	15
T5 Look up a club someone mentioned	Mixed: “debate” found nothing	A search box on the home screen; search understands everyday words	**Built, not tested**	13–14

Changes that help every task

Change	Why
VUW green palette and a club-night photo (pages 8–9, 14)	Liv and Theo preferred the green VUW look to the black homepage
Posters open on the second click; no automatic preview; videos start muted	Moving posters and sound got in the way. The golem was not made quieter yet
No fake links on the home screen	Underlined text looked clickable but did nothing

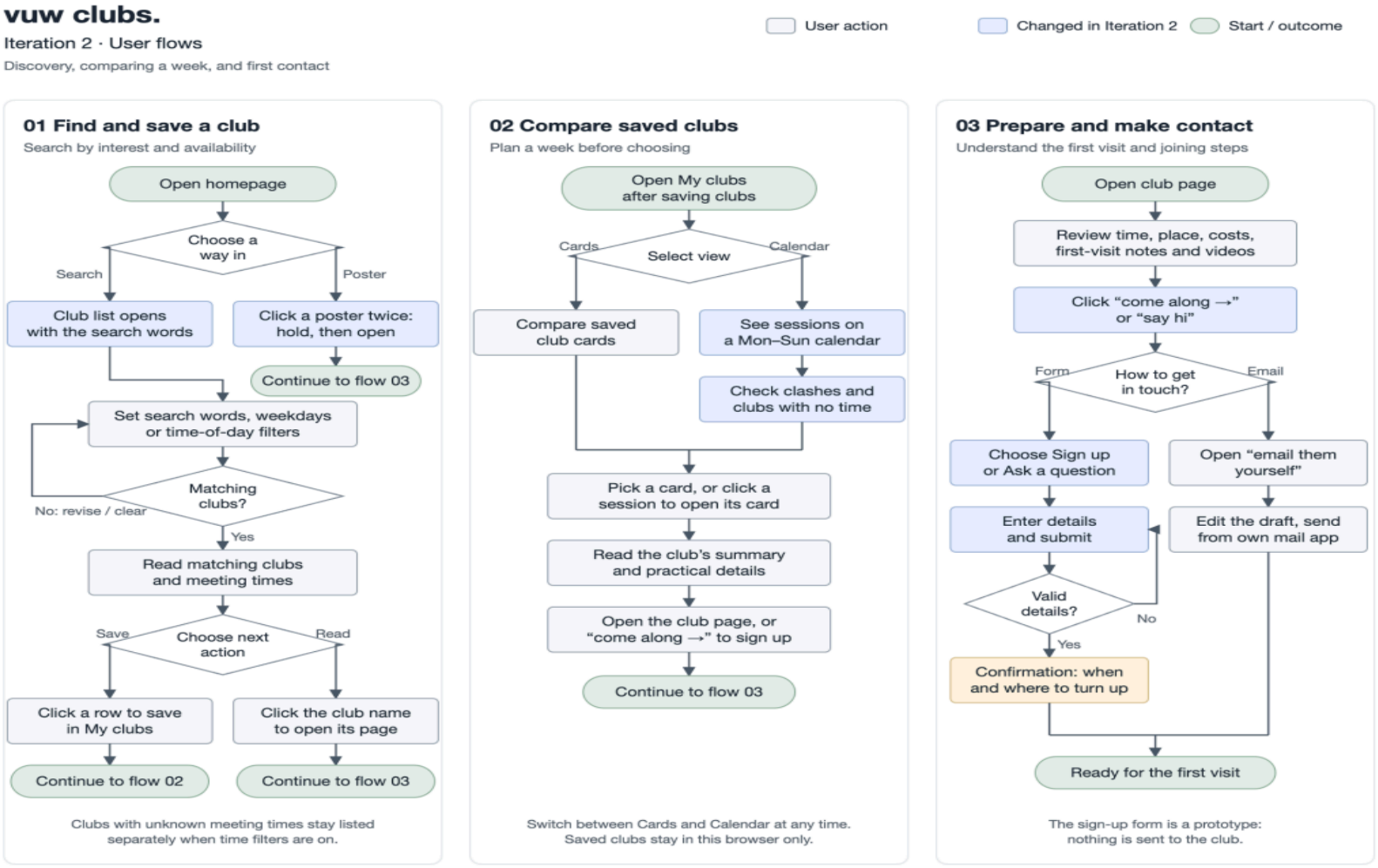
Smaller changes from the sessions, and requests

Built	How
Every club page looks the same (Liv)	Each desk has the club’s own drawn objects (page 16)
Give the calendar its own colour (Ben)	Red date tiles, like a calendar app
Group the prices “like a menu” (Ben)	All prices on one “costs” line in first-time.note
Mark the event the club is known for (Ben)	That event shows the club’s poster in the calendar
Person icon on members’ quotes (Ben)	Members’ messages show initials
Video progress bar too small	Thicker bar, thicker again on hover
Not built	Calendar export: the week view already shows clashes. Campus filter: five of six clubs meet on Kelburn. Reviews and friends who joined: need accounts

02 DURING DESIGN / USER FLOWS

Three flows: find and save, compare, make contact

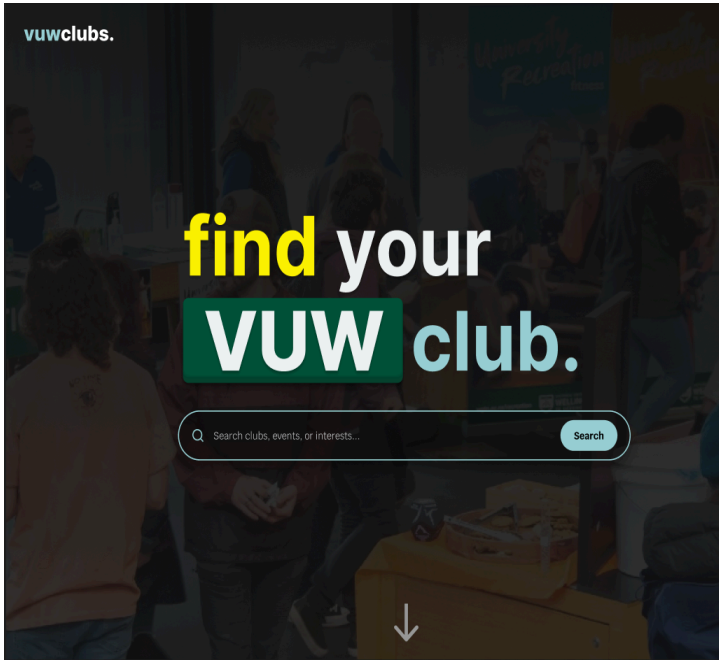
Iteration 2 keeps Iteration 1’s structure. Blue boxes are steps that changed in Iteration 2.



02 DURING DESIGN / FIGMA DESIGNS

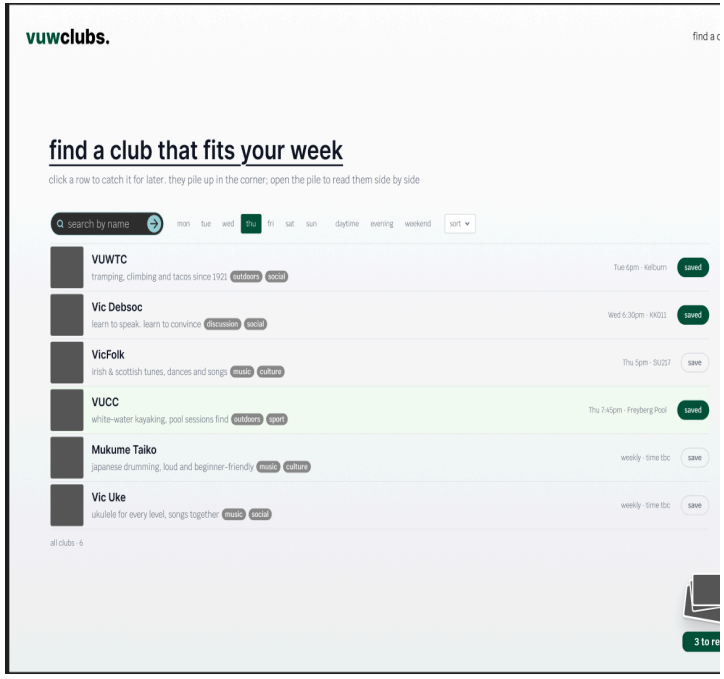
Figma designs: home, the club list and my clubs

Drawn in Figma before building, in the new palette. Grey boxes stand for photos and videos.



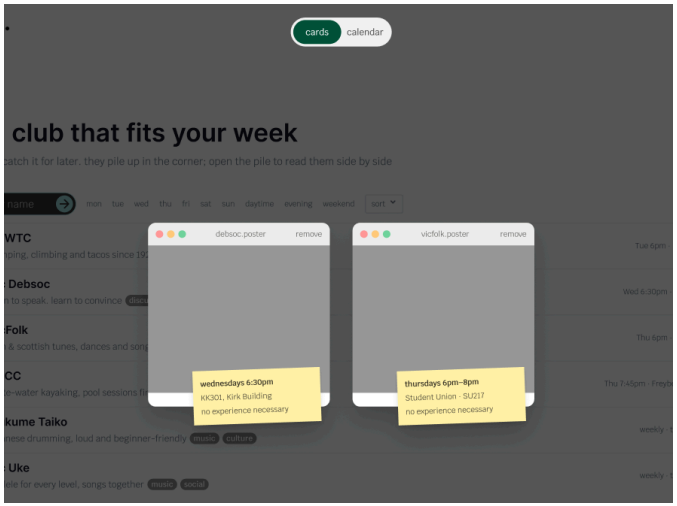
HOME

One photo and one search box, with “find a club” and a scroll arrow.



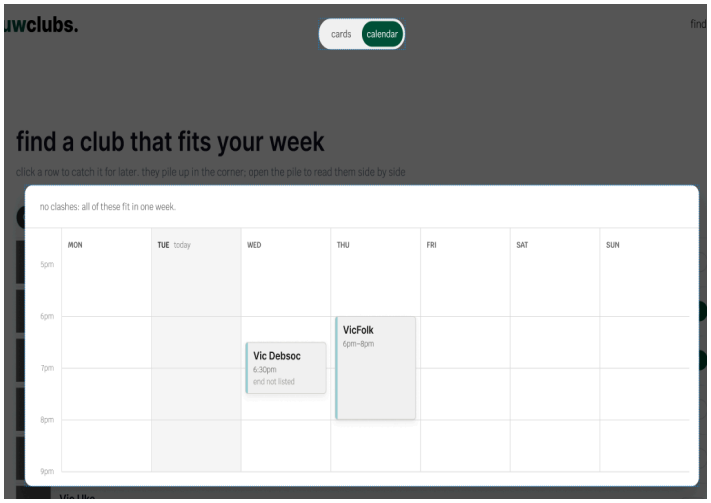
FIND A CLUB

One bar holds search, mon to sun, daytime, evening and weekend.



MY CLUBS: CARDS

Opening the pile lays each club out as a poster with a yellow note.



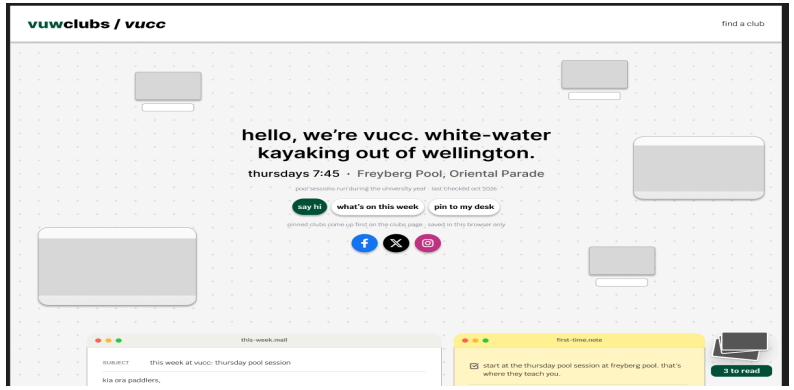
MY CLUBS: WEEK

A toggle switches to a Monday-to-Sunday grid, with today marked.

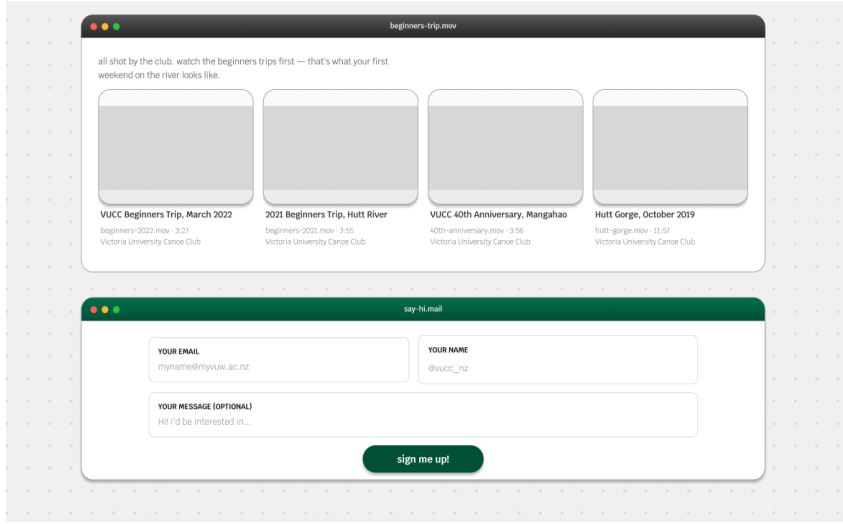
02 DURING DESIGN / FIGMA DESIGNS

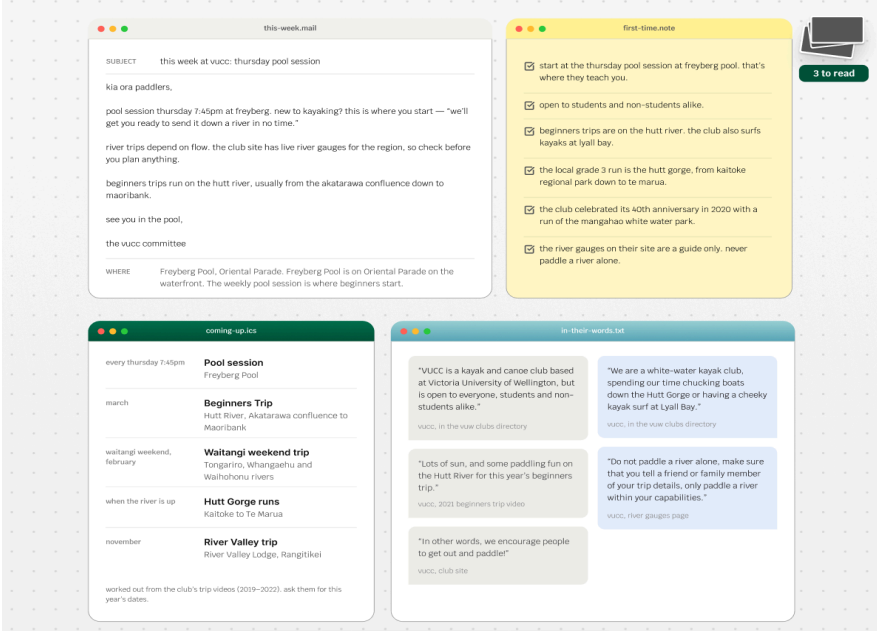
Figma club page: one structure, six windows

Every club page uses the same six windows, filled with that club's content. Each answers one question, and each title bar has its own colour so the windows are easy to tell apart.



Window	Question it answers
this-week.txt	What is on this week, and where?
first-time.note	What should a newcomer know before the first visit?
coming-up.ics	What is on later in the year?
in-their-words.chat	What is it like, in members' words?
a video, e.g. beginners-trip.mov	What does a session look like?
say-hi.mail	How do I sign up, or ask first?





A unified and accessible design scheme

Palette Considerations

The Color Palette we decided to move forward with was based around the two core colors of VUW's identity, with other colors being based around them with consideration taken for accessibility especially for colorblind individuals.

Colours

Emerald Depths
#01513B

Bright Lemon
#FEF200

Platinum
#EFF1F3

Frosted Blue
#9AD1D4

Minor modifications to these core hues were to be used as necessary when more colors were needed. Straying away from them was to be avoided where possible to enforce a consistent brand and ensure the motivation of the site was clear. Examples of these used in the final design are below. (etc. lighter/darker versions for gradients or highlighting).

Honeydew
#F0FDF4

Silent Yellow
#FFF2A8

Full White
#FFFFFF

Seattle
#58A5B7



Example Branding Generated by https://coolors.co/

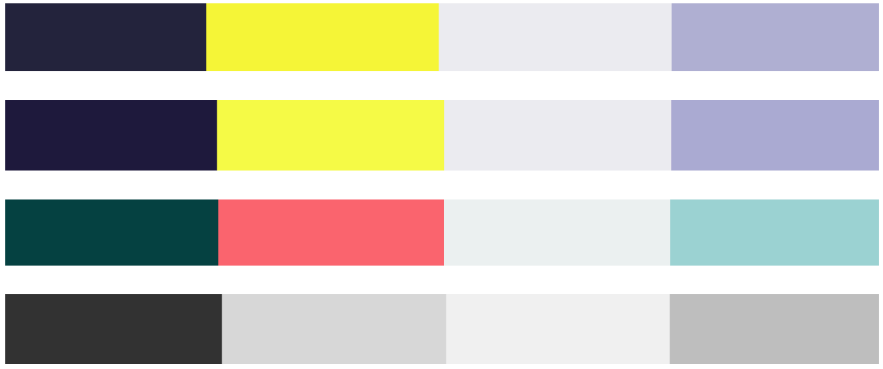
Emerald Depths *is to be used for interactive components on light screens and big VUW branding, and* ***Frosted Blue*** *is to be used on dark screens for interactivity.*

Platinum *is to be used as the replacement for white, on text or on backgrounds depending on corresponding themed color.* ***Full White*** *can be used in conjunction for further hilighting/creating a raised appearance ontop of it.*

Bright Lemon *is for any text/components that need special highlighting, but it must be used in a way that information remains legible as yellow can be hard to work when it comes to contrast with on occasion.* ***Silent Yellow*** *is to be used in cases where* ***Bright Lemon*** *may come off as too strong or unreadable, such as when text needs to be on top.*

It was possible to deviate from this as necessary, but sticking to picking from these colors allowed us to ensure the majority of our website did not have any accessibility issues and was aesthetically pleasing. Below is the same pallete in the four most common types of colorblindless, showcasing it still contrasts well regardless.

How the palette appears in the 4 most common types of colorblindness.



Font Considerations

We decided to use Inter for the headers, and Krub for the body text. This combination of fonts was specifically highlighted by Figma (https://www.figma.com/resource-library/font-pairings/) to be excellent for displays on screens and being very visually clear, avoiding hard-to-read text where communicating information effectively is key.

- 128px: used for headings that take up the majority of the screen.
- 40px: used for core page headings that need to be emphasized.
- 32px: used for the top left website name branding.
- 24px: used for subheadings
- 18px: used for card (club searching) headings.
- 16px: used for item headings + buttons.
- 14px: used for body text, badges, and video titles.
- 12px used for labels, captions, and metadata.

Type

Inter · 40 px
Page Headings

hello, we're vucc.

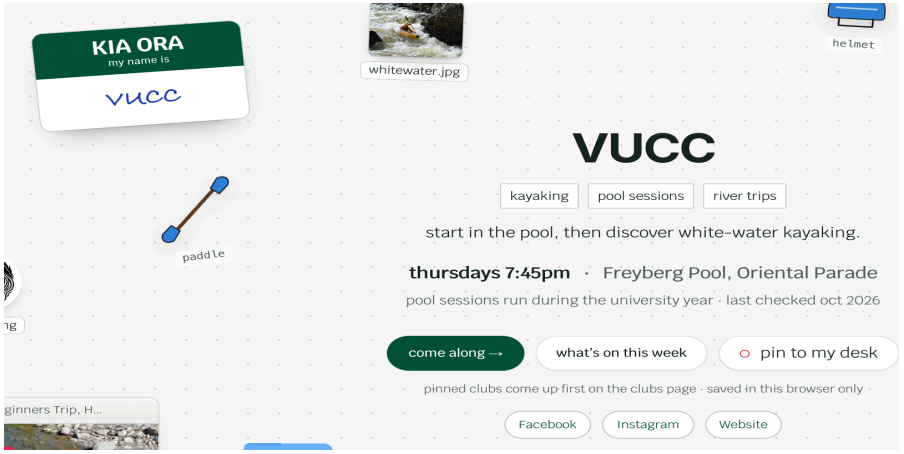
Krub · 14 px
Body Text

pool sessions run during the university year

IN THE BUILT SITE

Emerald Depths on the "VUW" block, the name tag and "come along →"; Bright Lemon and Frosted Blue in the home title; Inter headings over Krub body text.

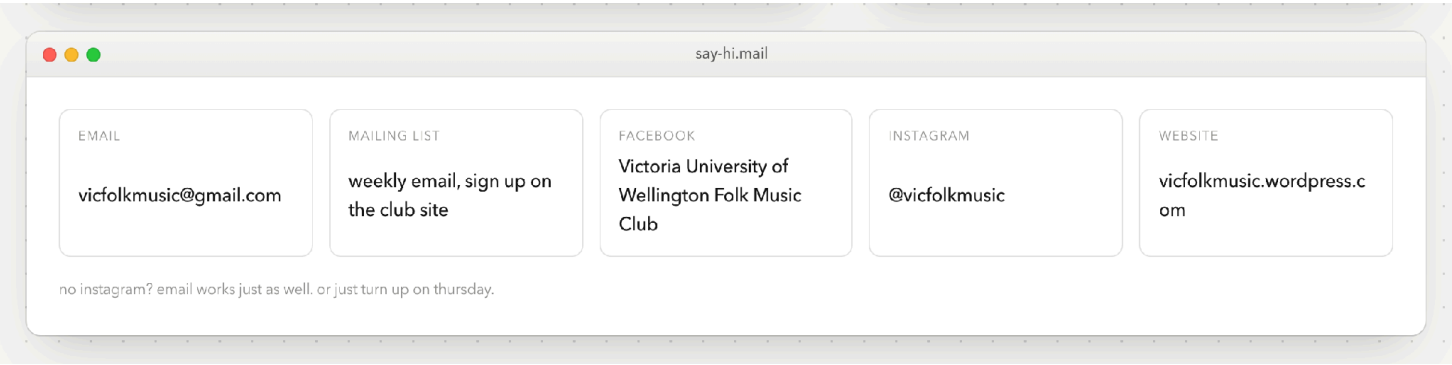




02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 1 OF 7 · TASK T3

Joining: from contact cards to a sign-up form

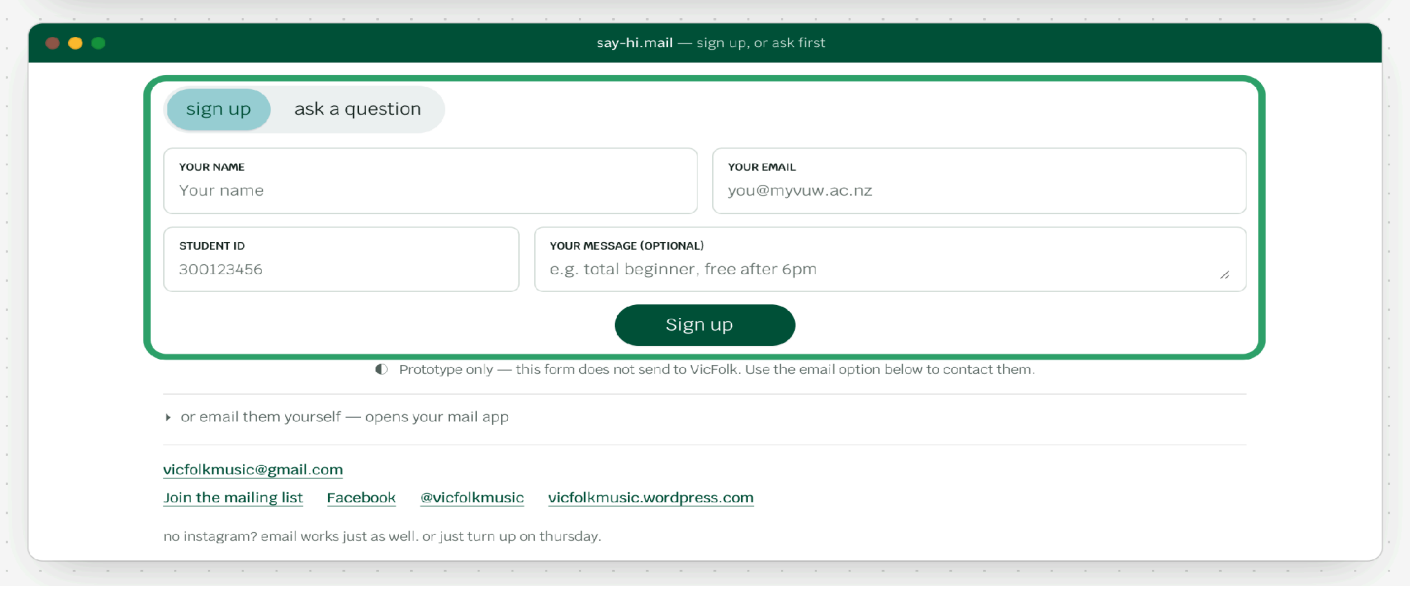
ITERATION 1



WHAT TESTERS MET

Five ways to contact the club, and none says “join”. Ben wanted a form instead: “If it’s on the page: click, green, I’m in.”

ITERATION 2



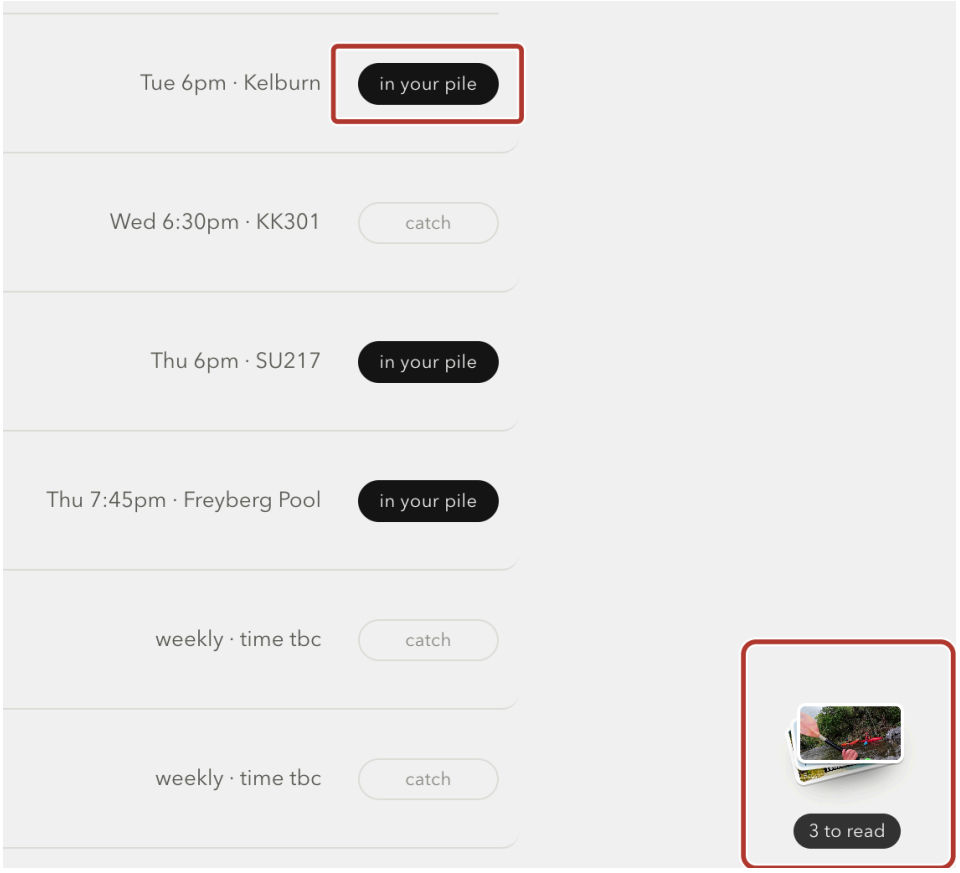
WHAT CHANGED

The window opens on a sign-up form, with an “ask a question” tab. Contacts shrink to one line below.

02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 2 OF 7 · TASK T1

Saving: “catch” becomes “save”

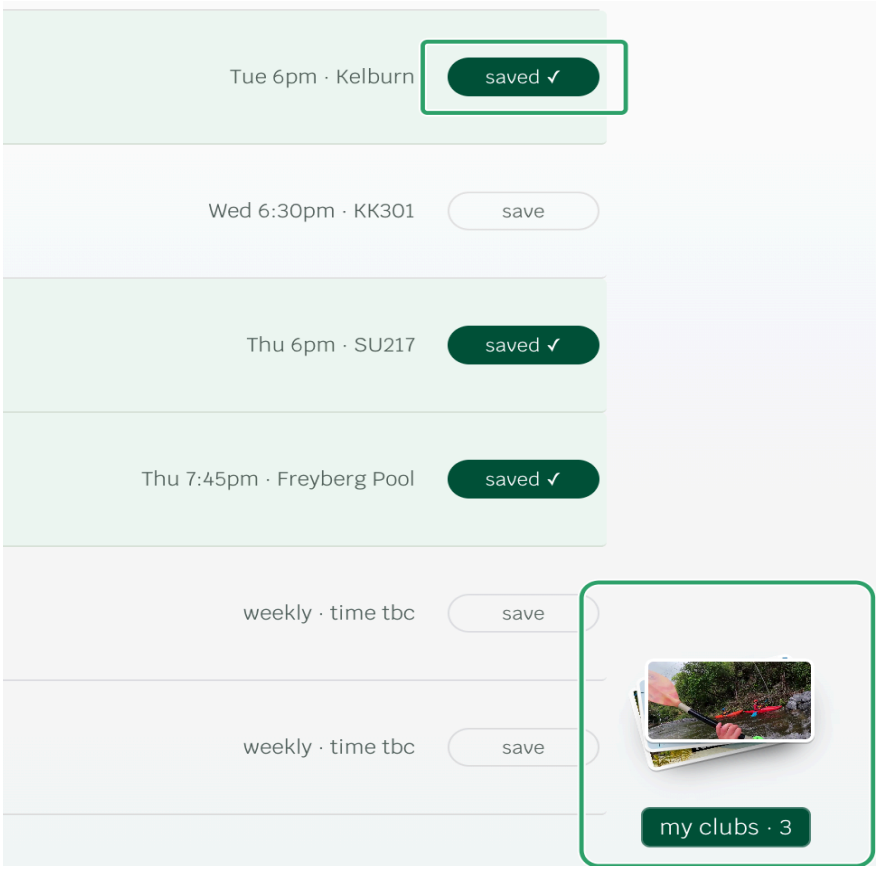
ITERATION 1



WHAT TESTERS MET

“catch”, then “in your pile”, and a small pile labelled “3 to read”. “They’re not fish.”

ITERATION 2



WHAT CHANGED

“save” turns to “saved ✓” and the row turns green. The pile is bigger and labelled “my clubs · 3”.

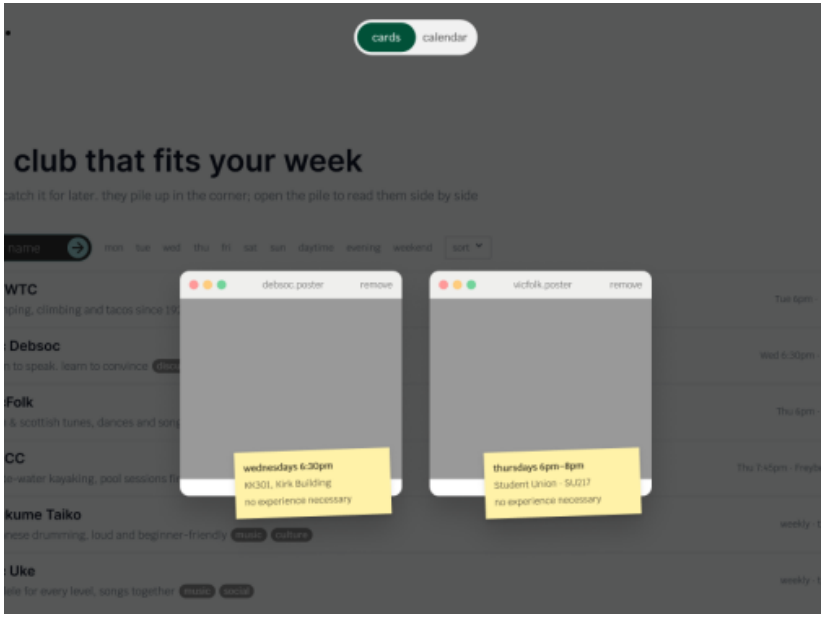
02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 3 OF 7 · TASK T1

Comparing: saved clubs on one week

ITERATION 1



ITERATION 2



WHAT TESTERS MET

One card per club. The Thursday clash between VicFolk and VUCC only shows by reading two cards.

Theo: “There is no obvious side-by-side view or comparison table.”

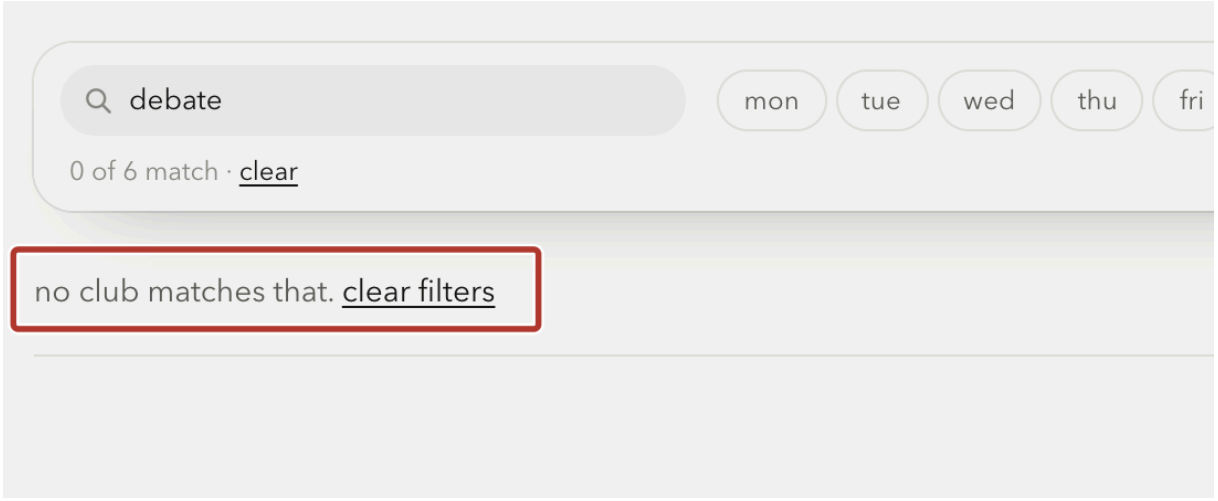
WHAT CHANGED

A “cards / calendar” switch. “calendar” puts every saved club on one Monday-to-Sunday grid and names the clash.

02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 4 OF 7 · TASK T5

Searching: “debate” finds Vic Debsoc

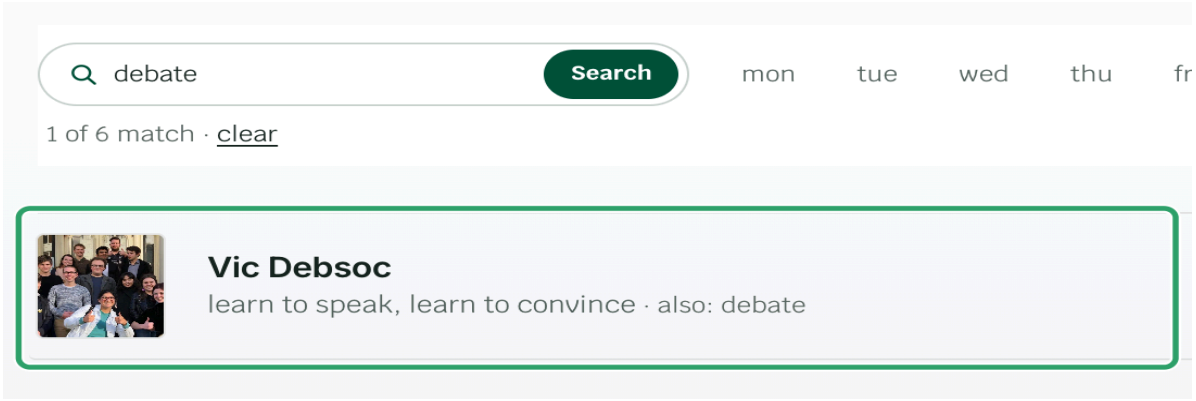
ITERATION 1



WHAT TESTERS MET

Search matched club names only, so “debate” found nothing.

ITERATION 2



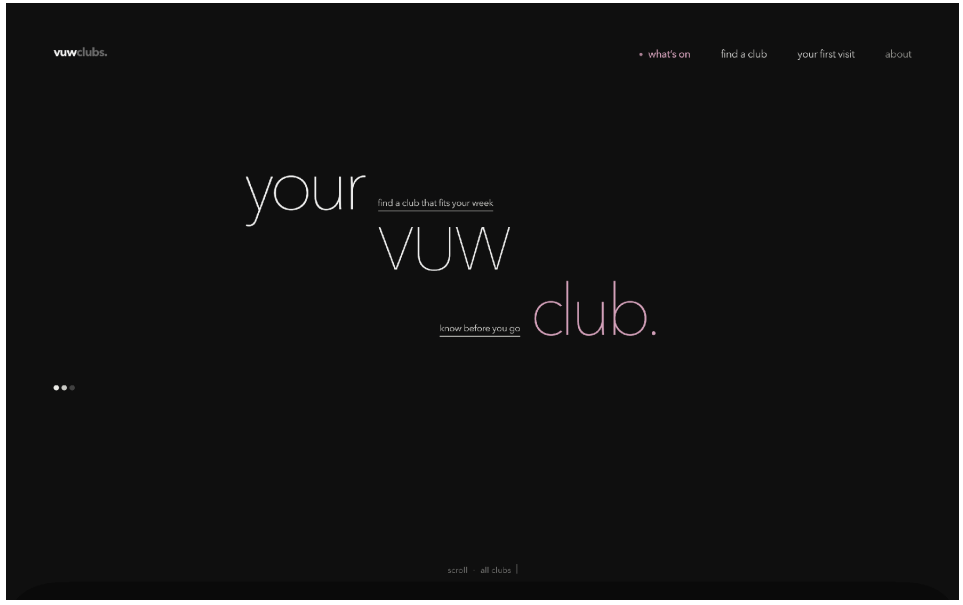
WHAT CHANGED

Search also matches everyday words, and the row says why: “also: debate”.

02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 5 OF 7 · TASKS T1, T5

Home: a VUW club night and a search box

ITERATION 1



WHAT TESTERS MET

A black screen. The underlined phrases looked like links but did nothing, and “scroll · all clubs” was hard to see.

ITERATION 2



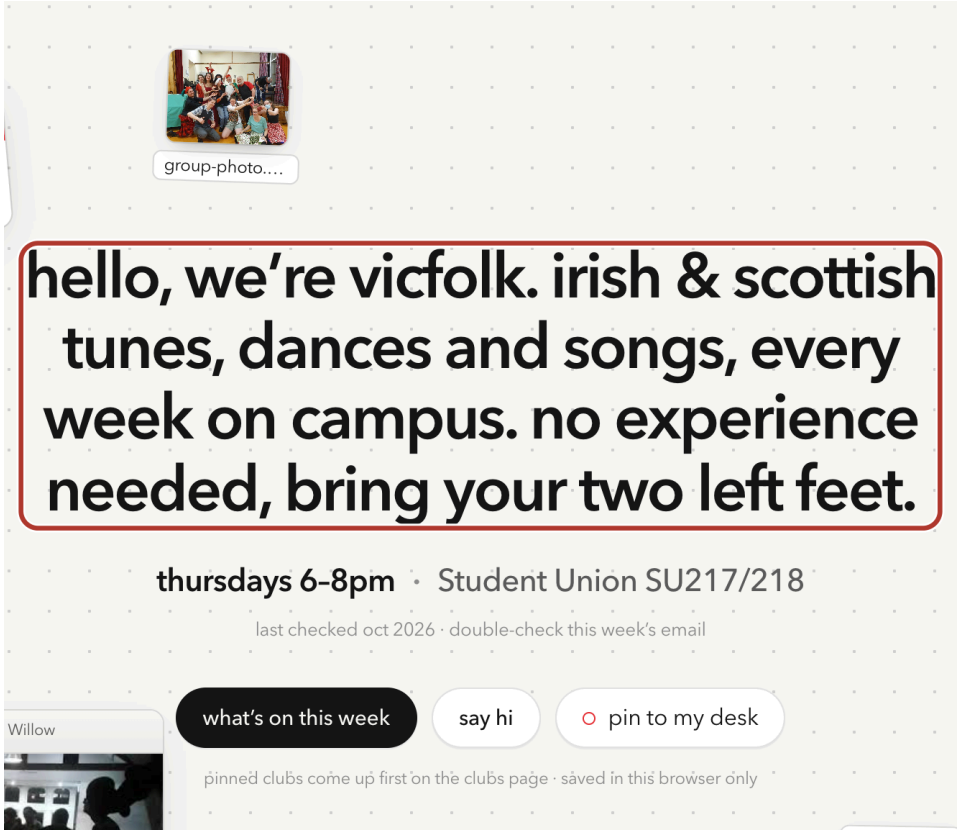
WHAT CHANGED

A club-night photo, a large “VUW club.” title and a search box. Scrolling down moves the same box into the list’s filter bar. The arrow opens the club list.

02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 6 OF 7 · TASK T2

Club page: name, tags and one next step

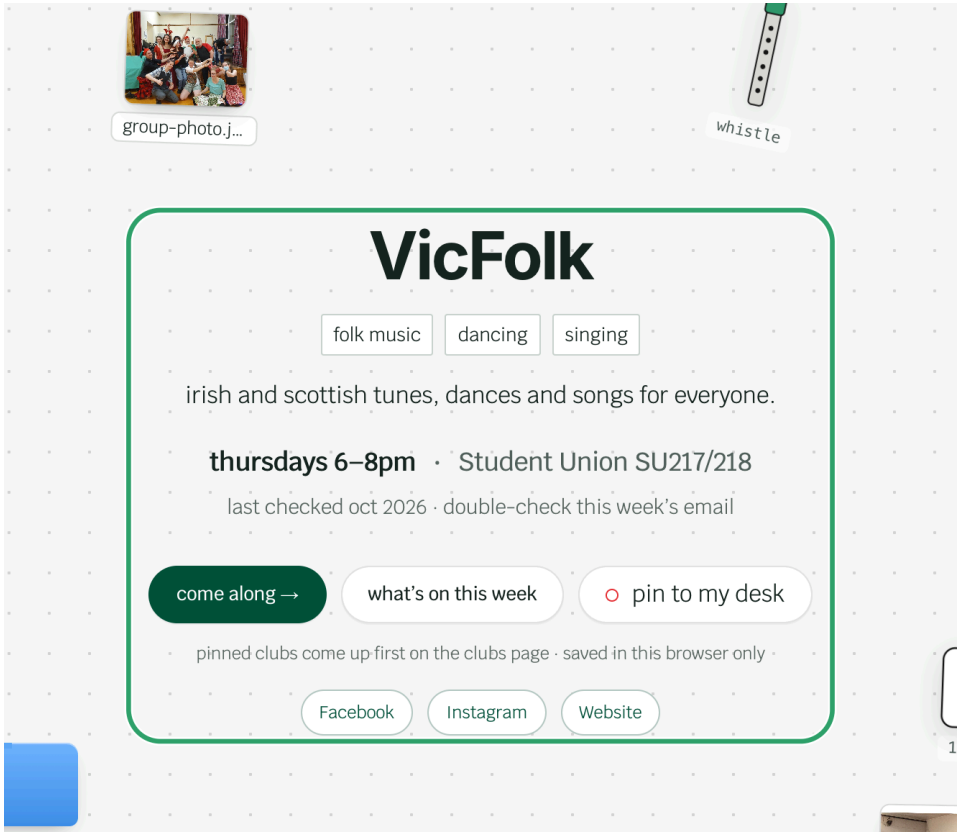
ITERATION 1



WHAT TESTERS MET

A long sentence about the club. Ben wanted points he "could just check, check, check".

ITERATION 2



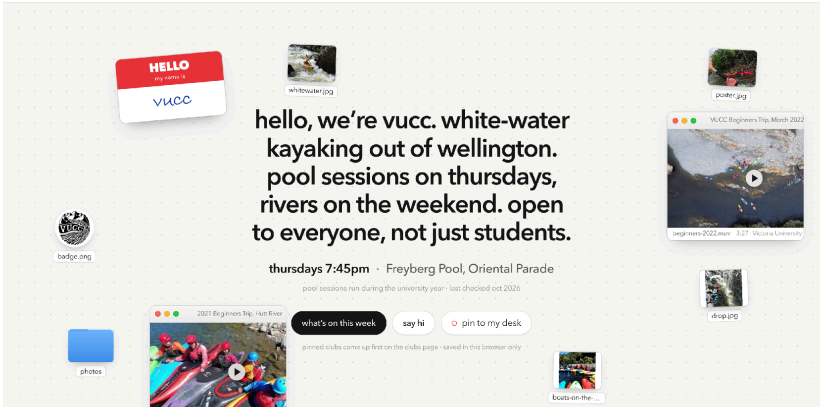
WHAT CHANGED

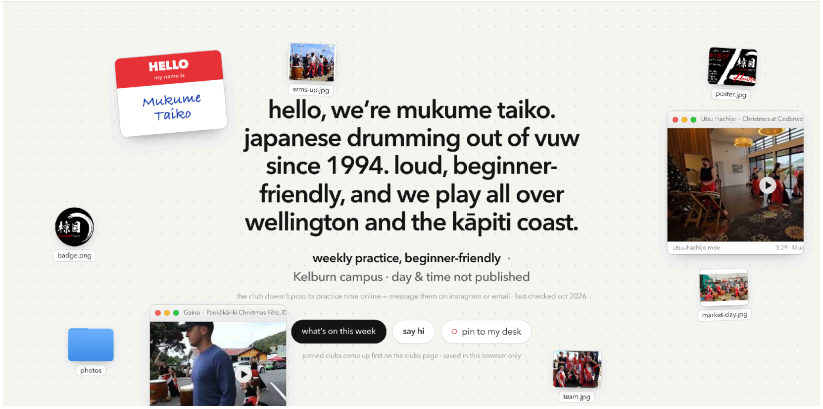
Name, three tags and one line, then time and place, "come along →" and the club's links.

02 DURING DESIGN / BUILT: BEFORE AND AFTER 7 OF 7 · TASK T2

Club pages: each desk has its own things

ITERATION 1

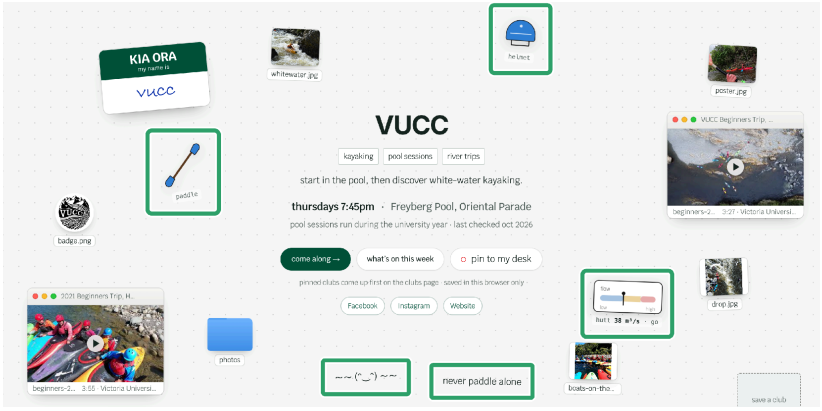


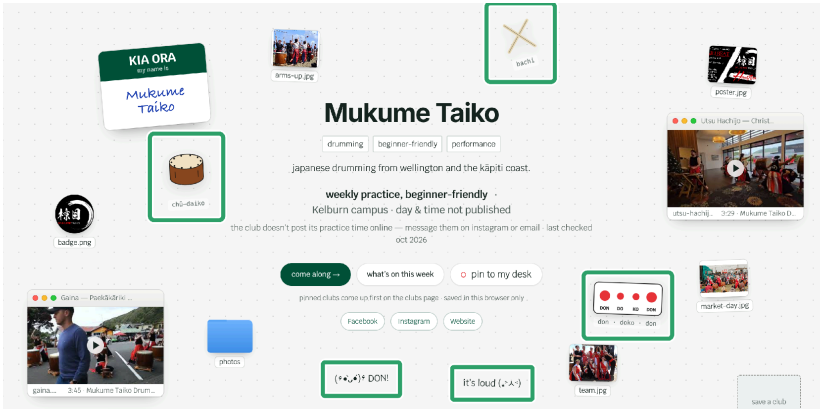


WHAT TESTERS MET

VUCC and Mukume Taiko share one layout; only the photos differ. Liv found every club page looked the same.

ITERATION 2





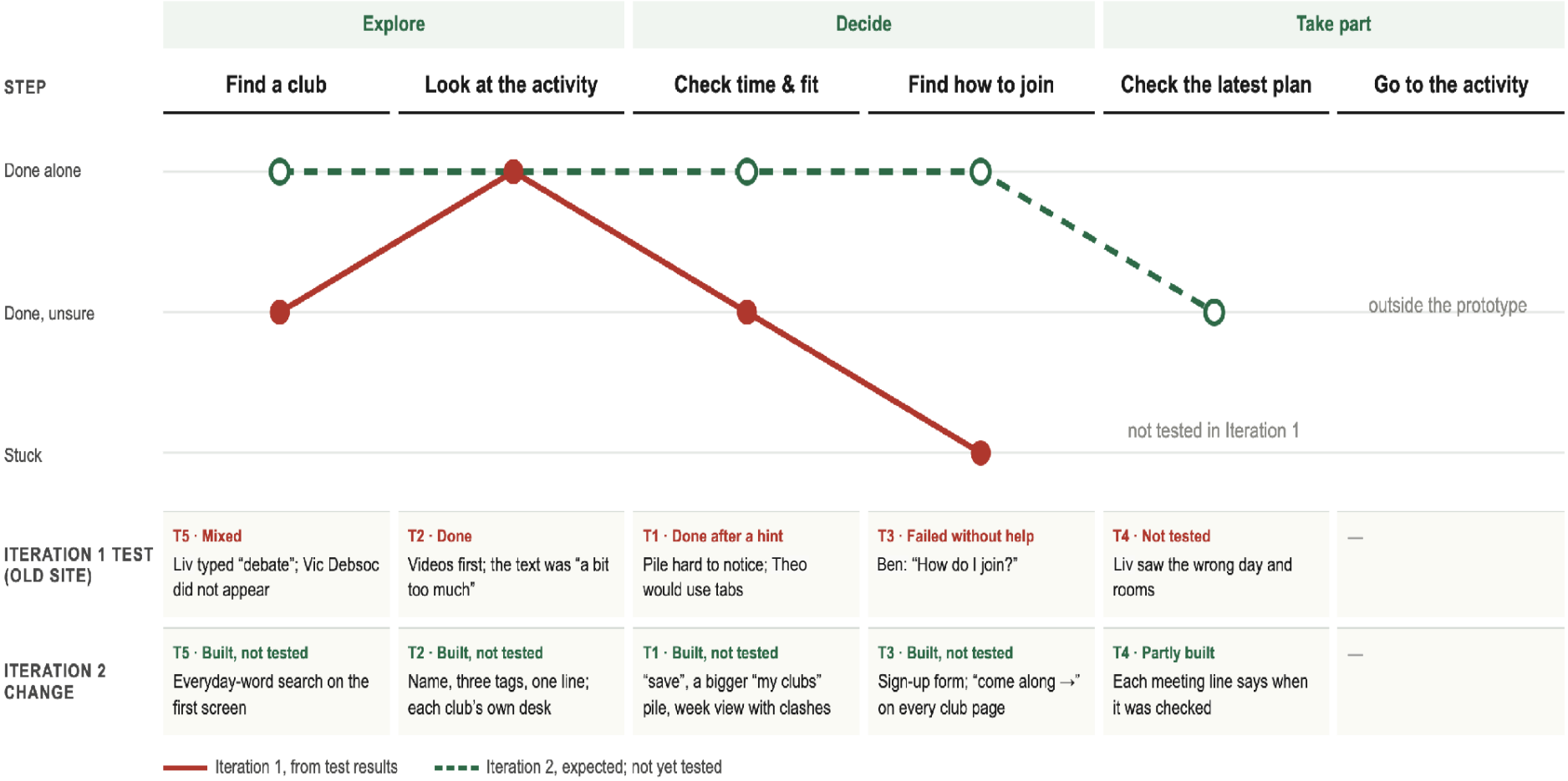
WHAT CHANGED

Each desk gets the club's own objects and a line of text: a paddle, river gauge and helmet for VUCC; a drum, bachi and rhythm card for Taiko. Drag one, or click it for a small reaction.

03 AFTER DESIGN / JOURNEY

Journey: where Iteration 2 should lift the curve

Steps and the hypothesised curve are from the Iteration 1 journey map. Red points are Iteration 1 task results; the low point, finding how to join, is where testers failed without help. The dashed line is a prediction: a point counts as moved only if new testers do that step without help (page 18).



03 AFTER DESIGN / TEST PLAN

Testing Iteration 2: same script, all five tasks

Iteration 2 has not been tested yet. Iteration 1's sessions used different scripts, one began with a demonstration, and none gave T4. The next round follows Liv: "I'm not going to teach you how it works unless you ask." No demonstration; one task read out at a time; the same words in every session.

Task	Iteration 1 (old site)	Read out	Passes if, without help, the tester…
T1 Find a club that fits my free time	Done after a hint	"You're free Tuesday and Thursday evenings. Find two clubs you could go to, and compare them."	saves two clubs and compares their times
T2 Decide if a club suits me	Done	"Pick one. Would you go this week? Why?"	answers with a reason taken from the club page
T3 Prepare for my first visit	Failed without help	"Get ready to go to that club for the first time."	sends the sign-up form and can say where and when to go
T4 Check the latest plan before going again	Not tested	"It's a week later. Is this week's meeting still on, and where?"	finds this week's details and when they were last checked
T5 Look up a club someone mentioned	Mixed	"A friend mentioned a debating club. Is it worth a look?"	finds Vic Debsoc by searching, then decides

Iteration 1's open questions, asked again

Question from Iteration 1	Iteration 2 change	Watch for
Does "catch" explain itself?	Now "save" and "my clubs"	Opens my clubs again without asking
Are file names enough to tell the windows apart?	Each window also looks like its app	Finds this week's room without opening every window
Does the golem help, or distract?	Unchanged apart from gown and greeting	Whether a tester stops a task to play with him
Is a name and a few videos enough to get a feel for a club?	Three tags and one line under the name	Decides on Vic Debsoc in about a minute, as Ben did in Iteration 1

Record each task as done alone, done with help, or not done, and the step where the tester stopped. Ask the same 0–10 ease-of-use question at the end of every session, so ratings can be compared.

03 AFTER DESIGN / NIELSEN REVIEW, THEN

Jay Cavers' Nielsen review of Iteration 1, and what Iteration 2 did

No issues were found for error prevention or for help and documentation.

Heuristic	Issue in Iteration 1	Suggested	Status	Iteration 2	Page
Visibility of system status	"scroll · all clubs" is faint	A bigger arrow	Fixed	A large arrow and "find a club" open the club list	14
Match with the real world	"catch", "pile" and "say hi" are not common words	Common words	Partly	"save" and "my clubs"; "say hi" stays as the button that opens the sign-up form	11
Match with the real world	this-week.txt opens an email-style window	Rename it	Not yet	Still this-week.txt	—
User control and freedom	Videos cannot go full screen	A full-screen option	Not doing	The clips are short previews; no tester asked	—
User control and freedom	No search on the home screen	Search on the main menu	Fixed	Search box on the first screen; on scroll it moves into the list's filter bar	14
Consistency and standards	The top bar changes between pages	One consistent top bar	Fixed	Every page: the logo goes home, "find a club" opens the list	—
Consistency and standards	Underlined home text looks like links	Remove it	Fixed	Removed; the home screen has a title and search only	14
Recognition rather than recall	"weekly · time tbc" gives no hint where to look	Link the club's social pages	Fixed	Each meeting line says where the club posts changes; social links sit under the time	15
Flexibility and efficiency	No interest tags	Tag categories	Partly	Three tags on each club page; not yet on list rows or as a filter	15
Flexibility and efficiency	No way to sort the list	Alphabetical sort	Not doing	Six clubs fit on one screen; day and time filters narrow them	—
Aesthetic and minimalist design	Home hierarchy unclear: small text between large titles	Remove the small text	Fixed	One title and one search box	14
Aesthetic and minimalist design	Practical information is spread out	Put it at the top	Fixed	Time, place and "come along →" under the club name	15
Aesthetic and minimalist design	Chat bubbles do not fit their text	Size bubbles to messages	Not yet	Bubbles still fill the window width	—
Help users recover from errors	An empty filter still shows other clubs	Say "No matching clubs found!" first	Fixed	"no club has published a time that fits", then the clubs with no published time	—

03 AFTER DESIGN / NIELSEN REVIEW, NOW

Iteration 2 against the same ten heuristics

The team's review of the Iteration 2 build. Cons are candidates for Iteration 3.

Heuristic	Pros	Cons
Visibility of system status	"saved ✓", a green row and the "my clubs · 3" count confirm a save; say-hi.mail becomes sent.mail after sending	Moving posters give no sign of which one will open
Match with the real world	"save", "my clubs", "sign up"; the calendar looks like a calendar	File names (.txt, .ics, .mail) are computer terms; "AGM" is not explained
User control and freedom	Saved clubs can be removed; any window folds with its yellow light	No full-screen video; no undo after removing a saved club
Consistency and standards	Every club page has the same six windows in the same places, under one top bar	Window controls copy macOS, which Windows users may not recognise
Error prevention	The sign-up form checks the details before sending	Saved clubs live only in this browser; clearing it loses them
Recognition rather than recall	Tags, time and place under each club name; the week view shows saved clubs together	"pin to my desk" and "save" are two separate lists to remember
Flexibility and efficiency	Search from the home screen with everyday words; day and time filters	No sort; no calendar export
Aesthetic and minimalist design	Name, three tags and one line at the top; costs on one line	Moving posters and desk objects add a lot to look at
Recognise and recover from errors	An empty filter says why, then offers the clubs with no published time	A search with no match says "no club matches that." and suggests nothing
Help and documentation	first-time.note for newcomers; the golem answers questions; search shows example words	No help or FAQ page

TOOLS, AI USE AND SOURCES

How this report was made

Tools

Designs were drawn in Figma; the palette was built with Coolors. Iteration 2 is the same React 19, TypeScript and Vite site as Iteration 1, with hand-written CSS. Screenshots are taken at 1440 × 900 from the Iteration 1 build (10 October 2026) and the Iteration 2 build (21 October 2026) with the same clubs, searches and saved clubs, so each pair shows the same moment.

AI use

Cursor (AI-assisted coding) supported the Iteration 2 changes, the screenshot scripts and drafting of this report. All output was checked against the Iteration 1 report, the test transcripts and the running prototype. AI output is not user research evidence; every quotation comes from the Iteration 1 user tests.

Sources

[1] SWEN303 Group 4, vuw clubs. Iteration 1 report, October 2026.

[2] SWEN303 Group 4, Iteration 1 user test transcripts: Session 1 (Ben), Session 2 (Liv persona), Session 3 (Theo), October 2026.

[3] J. Cavers, Nielsen heuristic evaluation of Iteration 1, October 2026.

[4] Club content and media from the public pages and videos of VUCC, VicFolk, VUWTC, Vic Debsoc, Mukume Taiko and Vic Uke; credits are shown on each video in the prototype.

[5] J. Nielsen, “10 Usability Heuristics for User Interface Design,” Nielsen Norman Group, 1994, updated 2020.

[6] Coolors, https://coolors.co/; Figma, “Font pairings,” https://www.figma.com/resource-library/font-pairings/.